men from less accommodating regimes in the Muslim world began drifting to Fatehpur Sikri. Hakim Abul Fath, Hakim Humam, and Hakim Nuruddin were three brothers who had had to flee the increasingly intolerant rule of Shah Tahmasp. The shah had seized Gilan and tortured and murdered their father, who had served as sadr of Gilan. These brothers had acquired training in medicine from Persia which was, at the time, famous for its tutor-based model of medical education. The brothers now came to Fatehpur Sikri where Abu'l Fazl remarked of Hakim Abul Fath that he was 'specially remarkable for his tact, his knowledge of the world and for his power to read the lines of forehead'. Even Badauni admitted that his manners 'were exceedingly winning' and that he became an intimate friend of the Padshah, though he grumbled that this was because 'he flattered him openly, adapted himself to every change in the religious ideas of His Majesty, or even went in advance of them'.

As the philosophical debates continued in the ibadat khana, the men alternatively exalted and furious, in the haramsara a discussion of a different sort had been occupying the women for many months, and would result in a journey that would take a large number of the women very far from the safe confines of their sandstone city and away from the 'proper order' that Abu'l Fazl yearned for the women of the harem.

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*A mansabdar could be paid in cash, or by the assignment of a jagir, in which case he was also a jagirdar of that land. There was, therefore, a close correlation between jagirdars and mansabdars. If the mansabdar was paid in cash, then he could not also be called a jagirdar.

*The word hukm is still used today in some states when addressing an erstwhile maharaja.

*The ibadat khana has been located by Syed Ali Nadeem Rezavi as the structure erroneously known as the Daftarkhana.

*A temporary marriage that unites a man and woman as husband and wife for a limited time.

*An Indian Sunni theologian of the Naqshbandi order. He would later join Akbar's court as a junior member, and would become a vocal critic of Akbar's 'heretical' practices.

†The Sura of the Heifer.